



BEFORE

Since the 8th century, interaction between the Islamic world and the West has been marked with conflict and unease.

MUSLIM EXPANSION

The Prophet Muhammad was both a political and a spiritual leader. By the time of his death in 632 CE, all of Arabia was **united under Islam**. His first successor, Abu-Bekr, proclaimed a Holy War against Byzantium and Persia. Palestine was captured and Egypt seized. In 711 CE a force of 7,000 Arabs invaded southern Spain << 174–77.



SELJUK TURKS

At the beginning of the 11th century a great wave of Seljuk Turks << 177, 206, led by Tughril Beg, conquered Iran. His successor, Alp Arslan, led the Seljuks to conquer Georgia, Armenia, and much of Asia Minor. They overran Syria and in 1071 defeated the Byzantine emperor Romanus IV in eastern Turkey << 199. This gave the Seljuk Turks a reputation as defenders of Islam and was a major factor in starting the Crusades << 200–01.

SELJUK
BOWL

OTTOMAN EMPIRE

A number of Islamic states emerged during the 16th century. The largest was the Ottoman Empire << 246–47, which grew from its original base as a Turkish warrior state in western Anatolia. Ottoman forces took Constantinople in 1453 << 207 and Syria and Egypt in 1516–17. In South Asia, Babur founded the Mughal Empire << 244–45. **Islamic teachings** were carried around the world by missionaries and merchants.

MILITARY LEADER (1881–1922)

ENVER PASHA

Enver Pasha was born in the Black Sea town of Apana in 1881. Enrolling with the military, he was posted to Greece, where he joined a secret group hoping for modernization of the Ottoman Empire. In 1908 Pasha was one of the leaders of the Young Turks that rebelled against the rule of the Sultan Abdul Hamid. During World War I, as minister of war, he aligned Turkey with Germany and Austria–Hungary. On defeat in 1918, Pasha fled to Turkistan, where he was killed in 1922.



Modernizing the empire

Constantinople, at the heart of the Ottoman Empire, was modernized from the 1870s onward with constructions such as the Galata Bridge (pictured), electric lights, a water system, streetcars, and telephones.

armed struggle, known as *jihad*.

A series of *jihad* revivalist movements led to the emergence of Islamist states in Nigeria, Libya, and the Sudan.

During the 19th century, European expansion became an increasingly important force in Muslim societies, and the major states that remained independent responded by undertaking a wide range of reforms. In the Ottoman Empire (see BEFORE) reforms began with attempts by Selim III, who reigned between 1789–1807, to institute a *Nizam-i cedid*, or “New System” of military and bureaucratic organization. His successor, Mahmud II, went on to restore the power and

The Young Turks Revolt

Five times a day millions of Muslims face Mecca to pray. Peace is the avowed aim, but the spread of Islam has not been without its conflicts. During its history, Muslim societies, such as the Young Turks and the Ottoman Empire, have struggled to define themselves in the modern world.

From the 11th century onward, Islam, under the leadership of the Turks (see BEFORE), had consolidated its hold on the Middle East and made further gains in India, East Asia, and Europe. However, by the 18th century, Europeans came to dominate much of the Muslim world from north Africa to southeast Asia, and this Western imperialism prompted a religious and political crisis.

Some believed that Islam could be restricted to private life and that public life might embrace modern, European ideas about technology, education, and law. One prominent modernist was Jamal Al-Din Al-Afghani (1838–97). Al-Afghani was a major catalyst for Islamic reform. He traveled all over the Muslim world strengthening communities in the hope of driving out the Western powers, but he was convinced that science and technology could be successfully adopted by Islamic

countries without compromise to their religion or culture. In the late 19th century, other modernists, such as the Indian Syed Ahmad Khan (1817–98), recommended the reformation of Islamic society along similar lines. He was responsible for founding the Muhammedan Anglo–Oriental College at Aligarh, northern India, in 1875, where Muslims could study Western ideas without alienating themselves from their religion.

Rejecting the West

Conservative Muslim leaders were convinced that Muslim impotence in the face of Christian imperialism was a result of divergence from Islam and deviation from their traditions. Many called for a total rejection of Western ideas. Some concluded that where Muslims no longer lived under Islamic rule in an Islamic territory, they were now in a state of warfare requiring

authority to the central government that had been usurped by powerful local lords. Mahmud II's successor, Abdülmecid I, who reigned from 1839–61, embarked on a program of reform that would become known as the *Tanzimat* (“reorganization”). As the empire sought to modernize, it gained the support of the British, and the Crimean War (1853–56) found Britain and the Ottomans allied against Russia. In 1876 Abd al-Hamid II came to the throne, and Russia declared war

ISLAMISM An ideology that considers Islam to be both a religion and a system of government. Islamist states are guided by *sharia*—Islamic religious law.

on the Ottoman Empire in 1877, in an attempt to liberate the Balkan Peninsula from Ottoman rule. In a swift campaign, the Russians drove the Ottomans back and forced them to sign the disastrous Treaty of San Stefano in 1878. This treaty deprived them of most of their European territories, including Bulgaria. Further territorial losses included the loss of Tunisia to the French in 1881 and Egypt to the British in 1882. In order to maintain greater control over the remaining empire, Abd al-Hamid continued the reform process. Great changes were made in education, military affairs,

“Turkey is a Muslim country, and Muslim ideas and influence must preponderate.”

YOUNG TURKS (COMMITTEE OF UNION AND PROGRESS), 1910